Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI61 61% Fe Fines RMB/t

785
-4 -0.51%
Apr 2nd, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

951
-3.00 -0.31%
Apr 2nd, 2026

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

716
-2 -0.28%
Apr 2nd, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI61 61% Fe Fines USD/dmt

106.50
-0.25 -0.24%
Apr 2nd, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

125.50
0.50 0.40%
Apr 2nd, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

893
-7 -0.78%
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2605 (May) RMB/t (3pm close)

805.00
-7.00 -0.86%
Apr 2nd, 2026 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
May 26 USD/dmt

106.30
0.00 0.00%
Apr 2nd, 2026 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2605 (Jan) RMB/t

3106
-14 -0.45%
Apr 2nd, 2026 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

30.21
0.03 0.1%
Apr 1st, 2026

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

11.24
0.30 2.8%
Apr 1st, 2026

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3154
0 0.00%
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

155.78
-0.61 -0.39%
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

14.65
-0.51 -3.37%
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3283
8 0.23%
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Apr 2nd, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	785	-4	-0.5%	787	827	683	1063	105.71	-0.34	-0.3%	102.70	108.07	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	716	-2	-0.3%	695	727	610	963	97.13	-0.08	-0.1%	91.16	95.62	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	951	-3	-0.3%	898	938	794	1175	128.90	-0.15	-0.1%	117.60	123.03	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Apr 2nd, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	106.50	-0.25	-0.24%	103.59	109.02	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	125.50	0.50	0.40%	115.96	123.72	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Iron ore futures showed a stronger trend in the morning session today but weakened in the afternoon. The main contract I2605 eventually closed at 805 yuan/ton, down 1.29% from the previous trading session. Spot prices fell by approximately 3–7 yuan compared to the previous day. Traders showed generally low enthusiasm for quoting, while steel mills made limited inquiries; as of now, spot market transactions are moderate.

In terms of fundamental data, inventory at the 10 sampled ports this week showed significant structural divergence. Notably, mainstream medium-grade ores such as PB fines and blended fines saw substantial inventory increases, with PB fines surging by 1.24 million tons to nearly 9 million tons. In contrast, grades such as Carajas fines, Ultrafines, and high-silicon Brazilian fines experienced counter-cyclical inventory drawdowns. This divergence indicates that, under current pressures on steel mill profitability, the consumption side is accelerating its shift toward cost minimization. Steel mills are broadly adopting a "barbell" blending strategy that pairs high-grade and low-grade ores, which has significantly squeezed demand for mainstream medium-grade ores, further weighing on upward momentum for iron ore.

On the macroeconomic front, amid persistently high overseas inflation and fading expectations of Fed rate cuts, tightening dollar liquidity has further dampened bullish sentiment in commodities. Combined with the pressure from high inventory levels at the micro level and weak demand for medium-grade ores, iron ore prices currently lack upward catalysts in the near term and are expected to maintain a range-bound, slightly weaker trend.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	893	-7	-0.8%	895	952	820	1210	115.54	-1.03	-0.88%	112.30	119.63	102.77	153.57

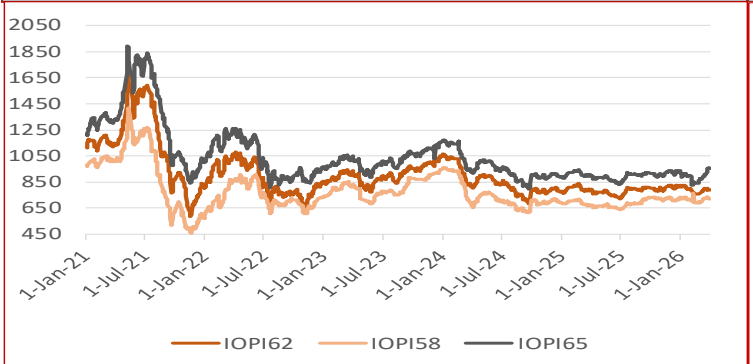
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	981	1.8%	859	1226	142.14	1.68%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	970	-0.5%	880	1300	140.54	-0.60%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	745	0.0%	690	970	107.94	-0.08%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1016	1.9%	878	1294	147.21	1.82%	122.53	182.16

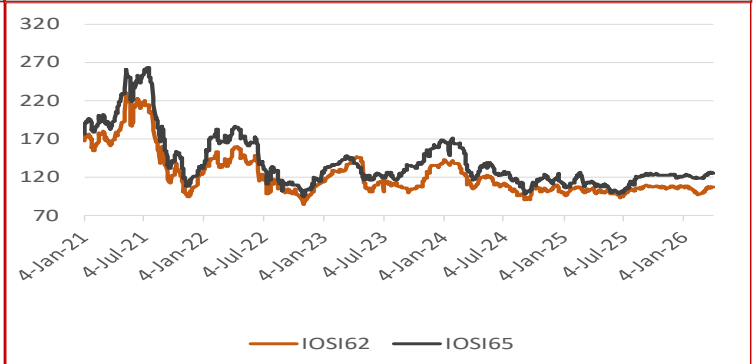
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	883.03	1.44%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Apr 2nd, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	798	810	769	787	**787**	783	827	100.24	107.43	102.60	105.74	**102.70**	102.08	108.07
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	716	719	699	716	**695**	690	727	94.72	96.04	93.94	96.95	**91.16**	90.48	95.62
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	925	900	852	906	**898**	893	938	122.17	119.85	114.11	122.37	**117.60**	117.01	123.03

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Apr 2nd, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	105.42	106.27	99.65	104.52	**103.59**	102.93	109.02
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	121.09	121.51	118.61	123.28	**115.96**	115.13	123.72

FREIGHT RATES

Apr 1st, 2026		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	11.24	0.30	2.8%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	30.21	0.03	0.1%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	864	875	844	894	**895**	891	952	110.83	111.50	108.31	115.65	**112.30**	111.88	119.63

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Apr 2nd, 2026		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-69	-8.79%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	166	21.15%

Apr 2nd, 2026		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	19.00	17.84%

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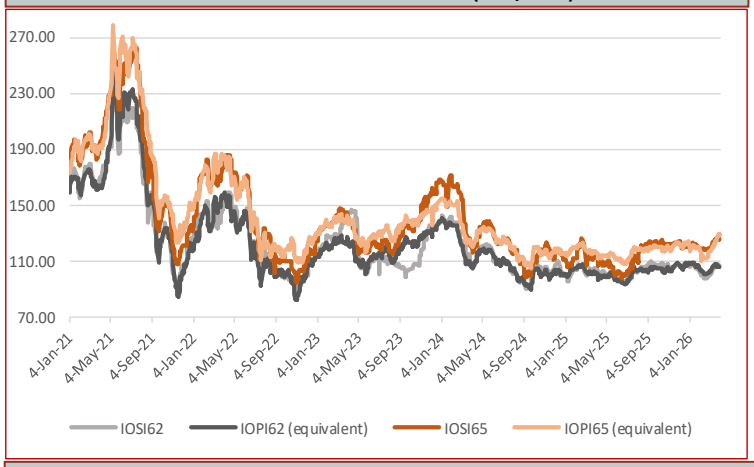
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Apr 2nd, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	731	0	-54
SIMEC Fines	756	0	-29
PB Fines	819	0	34
Newman Fines	811	0	26
MAC Fines	779	0	-6
Jimblebar Blended Fines	707	0	-78
Carajas Fines	967	0	182
Brazilian SSF	883	0	98
Brazilian Blend Fines	894	0	109
RTX Fines	701	0	-84
West Pilbara Fines	770	0	-15

Apr 2nd, 2026	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	99.80	-0.25	-6.70
SIMEC Fines	94.95	-0.25	-11.55
PB Fines	106.30	-0.25	-0.20
Newman Fines	103.25	-0.25	-3.25
MAC Fines	102.80	-0.25	-3.70
Jimblebar Blended Fines	95.40	-0.25	-11.10
Carajas Fines	125.85	-0.25	19.35
Brazilian SSF	102.55	-0.25	-3.95
Brazilian Blend Fines	112.95	-0.25	6.45
RTX Fines	95.65	-0.25	-10.85
West Pilbara Fines	97.10	-0.25	-9.40

Apr 2nd, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	666	0	-50
FMG Blended Fines	731	0	15
Robe River	730	0	14
Western Fines	692	0	-24
Atlas Fines	736	0	20
Yandi	706	0	-10

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	25.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	22.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	60.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	66.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	35.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	25.00	5.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	20.00	-8.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	20.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	28.00	8.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	15.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	15.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	6.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	7.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	7.75	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	6.75	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.75	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-20.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-18.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-3.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	0.00	Jingtang	-16.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-18.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-20.00	0.00

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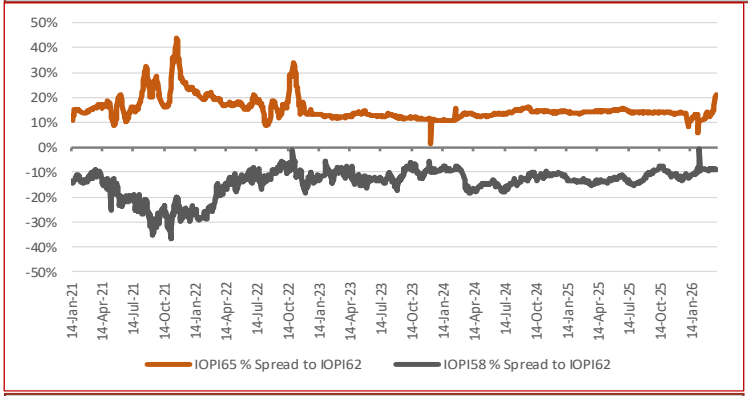
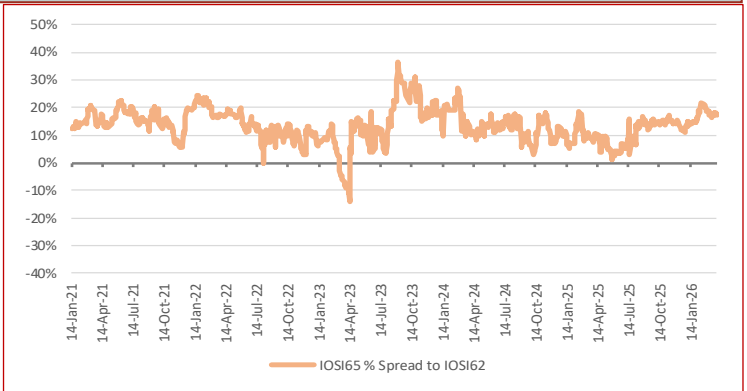
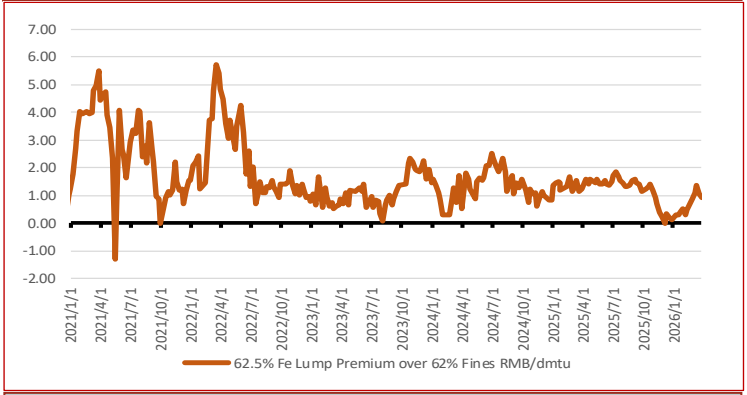
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

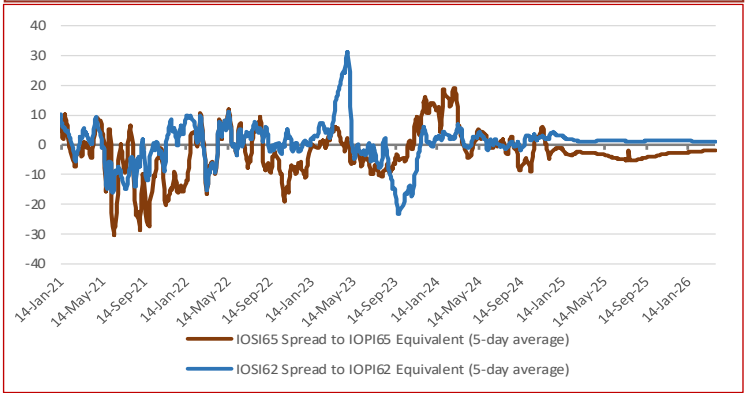




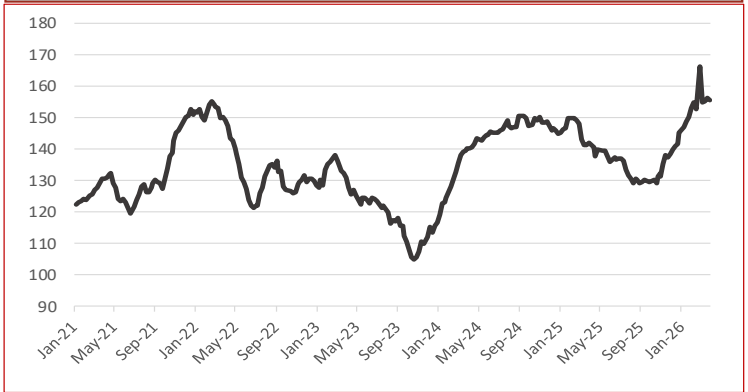
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



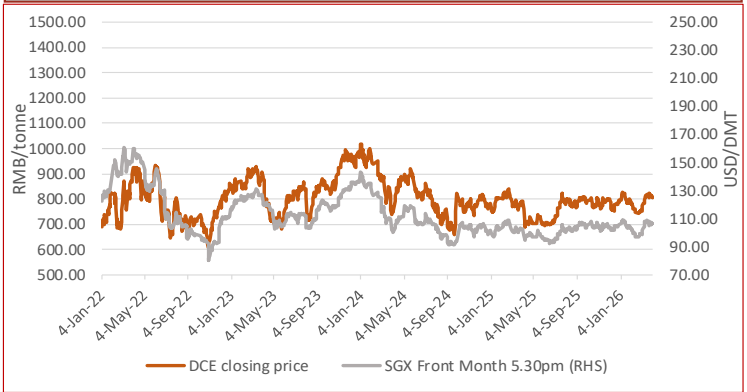
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

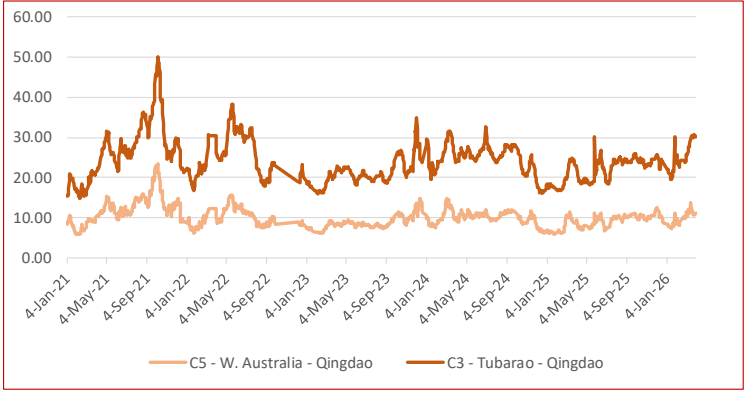
Week Ending Mar 27th, 2026

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	18.94	2.54%	8.29	18.94
Qingdao	32.70	1.24%	22.28	34.83
Caofeidian	17.66	-0.11%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	12.51	2.12%	6.64	12.52
Rizhao	11.41	-10.23%	11.41	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	155.78	-0.39%	105.01	166.39

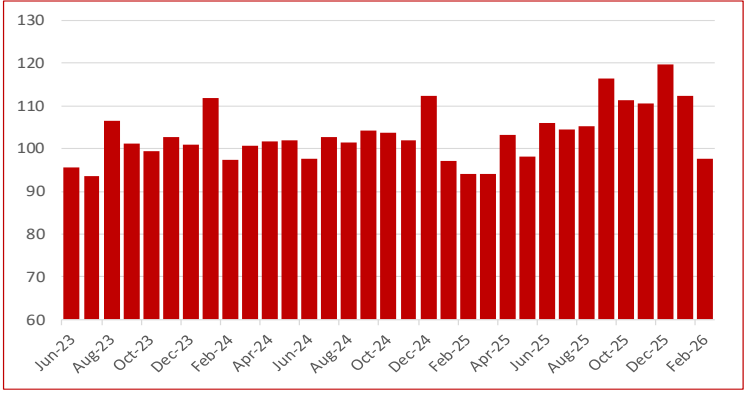
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Apr 2nd, 3pm close			Apr 2nd, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2605	Change	Change %	May. 26	Change	Change %
Closing Price	805.00	-7.00	-0.86%	106.30	0.00	0.00%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	34.02	14.28	72.34%	11.16	3.73	50.17%
Open positions ('000 lots)	32.02	-2.76	-7.92%	53.05	0.12	0.22%
Day Low	793.5	-14.50	-1.79%	104.50	-0.65	-0.62%
Day High	814.5	-7.00	-0.85%	106.65	-0.15	-0.14%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2026/03/27	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,154	0	0.00%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,348	-3	-0.09%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,283	8	0.23%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,793	10	0.26%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,393	10	0.30%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,053	0	0.00%
Colour Coated Plate	6,300	-50	-0.79%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

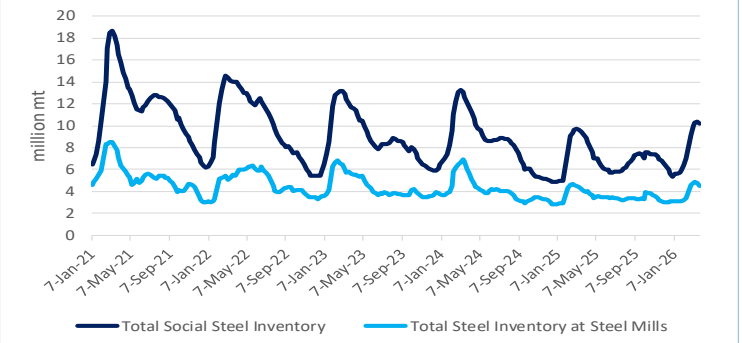
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	106.43	-0.84	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,605	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,450	-30	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,592	9	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,155	11	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-25	-11	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,219	7	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	71	-7	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

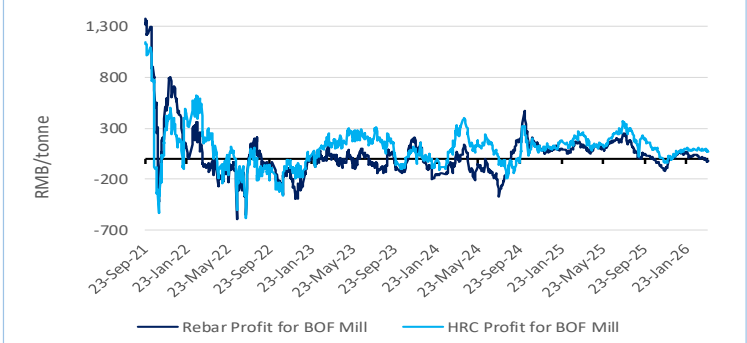
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

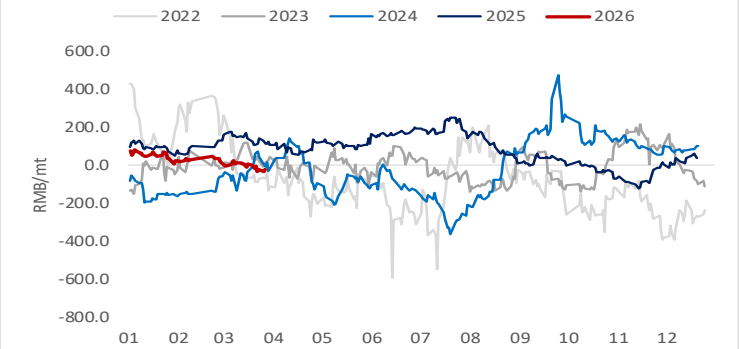
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



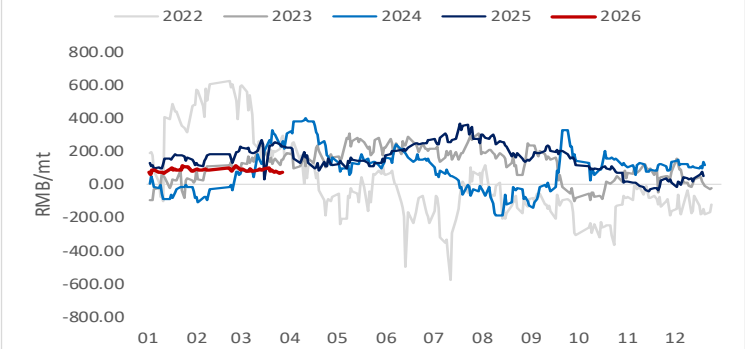
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



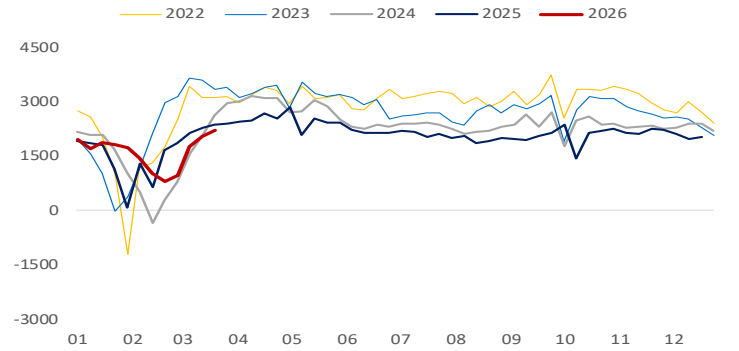
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



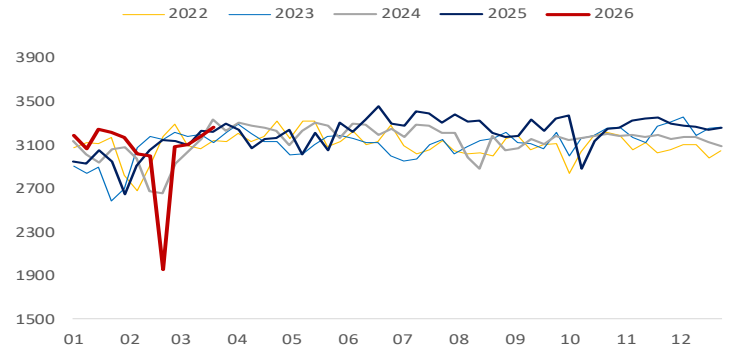
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



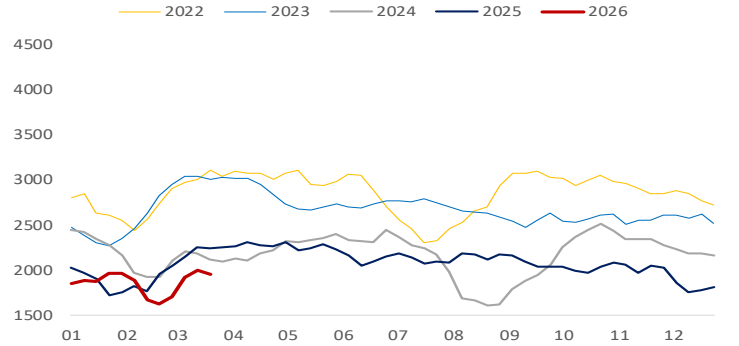
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



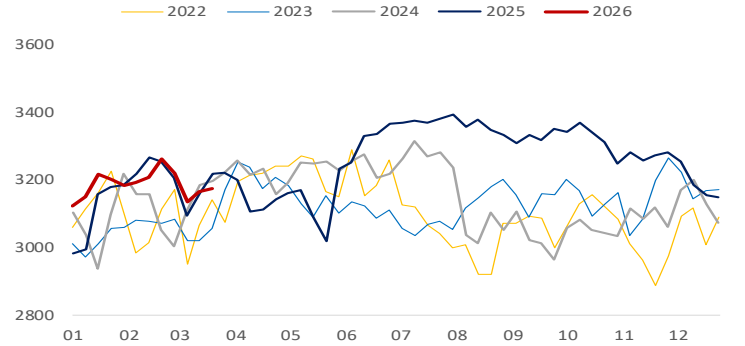
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Apr 2nd, 2026	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Apr 2nd, 2026	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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